

Have you noticed that Uranus and Neptune are missing from Nicolaus's model? It's because they hadn't been discovered yet!

A model astronomer

Nicolaus figured out that the Earth was just another planet orbiting the sun. He created a new model of the universe, called the heliocentric model. It put all the planets in the right order, and it even explained the seasons—more or less of the sun's heat reaches different parts of the Earth during its orbit, causing hot and cold periods.

Nicolaus didn't share his theory for more than 35 years. There were things he couldn't understand, such as why the moving Earth feels so still underfoot. He didn't get everything right—for example, he believed the stars orbit the sun, like the planets. But he helped turn astronomy into a studied science in which people question old ideas.



Nicolaus released a book of his ideas just before he died. It didn't sell many copies at first!



The element Copernicium was named in honor of Nicolaus.

Finally we shall place the sun himself at the center of the universe.

